

music In Concert

When you think of perfect jugalbandis, one remembers the chemistry between sarod maestro Ustad Ali Akbar Khan and sitar maestro, Pandit Ravi Shankar. "It is a meeting of mind and thoughts with each musician trying to interpret the raga and arriving at a common point," says renowned flautist Hariprasad Chaurasia.

Jugalbandis can end up in a disaster if that chemistry is missing. "In jugalbandis, you are no longer 'I' but 'we', so each one has to surrender a bit of one's individuality and have intuitive anticipation. It is team work. Each one has to inspire the other," says Pandit Ronu Mojumdar, flute maestro. The organisers are also to be blamed for holding too many jugalbandis due to which their quality has deteriorated over the years. The ordinary listener is lured by big names and often the marketing triumphs over music.

Chaurasia with Shiv Kumar Sharma (left)

Not so with "The Best of Jugalbandis" (Music Today), an excellent compilation with a rich array of musicians, which includes renditions by Ustad Bismillah Khan (shehnai), Ustad Amjad Ali Khan (sarod), Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma (santoor), Pandit Chaurasia (flute), Ustad Sultan Khan (sarangi), U. Shrinivas (mandolin), Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt (mohan veena) and Ronu Mojumdar (flute) among others.

Add to this the live-recorded album, "Milan: Melting Boundaries (Ninaad)" featuring Chaurasia and M. Balamuralikrishna (Carnatic vocal). The album is a perfect blend of their creative genius. The rhythm by percussionists Pandit Anindo Chatterjee (tabla) and Vidwan Vikku Vinayakram (ghatam) adds to the overall performance making it more appealing. The maestros conclude with a bhajan *bhajare guru dauvam manas* in raga Bhairavi, known for depicting the Bhakti rasa. Soak in the musical power of the duo.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



The Best of Jugalbandi, Music Today, Rs 330



SHAN TANKHA

art Worth the Wait

KOLKATA Most Kolkatans can't recall the last time the city hosted a Raza solo. The opening of Gallery K2 this month has, thus, been heralded by the city's art community. The gallery's inaugural exhibition will see a grand display of tapestries and serigraphs by Syed Haider Raza. Dinendra Singh, co-owner of the gallery, says that his team has been working with the legendary artist for the last three years, meticulously transforming some of his finest paintings into tapestries. The show features five limited edition tapestries and 11 serigraphs. The proceeds of the show will go to the Raza Foundation, which provides scholarships for talented individuals in creative fields. Raza, however, will not be able to attend the exhibition. On till July 7.

by Swagata Sen



A work by Syed Haider Raza

film festival A French Treat

DELHI The French Embassy and Alliance Francaise de Delhi come together to give French cinema lovers a taste of vintage Francois Truffaut with *Love Stories*, a cross section of films on the subject by the master filmmaker. Starting July 6 with *La Peau Douce*, there will be weekly screenings until August 24, with *Domicile Conjugal*, *Les Deux Anglaises et le*



A still from Le Dernier Metro *Continent, L'amour en Fuite, Le Dernier Metro, La Femme d'a Cote* forming the schedule. The selection provides a glimpse of Truffaut at his very best, in all his sensitivity and subtlety. by Gaurav Rajkhowa